

PITTSBURGH —This was the season when a lost boy was announced as a Chicago Cub pinchhitter, when the stork inspired a pitcher to victory, when a radio broadcaster and a manager swapped jobs and a Tiger nearly clawed the working arm of a pitcher.

The 1960 baseball season won't go into record books for another six weeks but it ranks as one of the looniest campaigns since Abner Doubleday discovered a diamond is a ballplayer's best friend.

Grady Hatton was sent to bat for Cub Pitcher Bob Anderson at Forbes Field. Pirate broadcaster Bob Prince, unable to see Hatton's number heard Art McKennan, public address announcer, say "Rab Mungee."

"The Cubs are sending in Rab Mungee to bat for Anderson Prince informed his listeners.

Just a Lost Boy

What Prince didn't learn until later was that Rab Mungee was a 12-year old boy lost in the ballpark.

The Pirates and the Cubs figured in another oddity. Pittsburgh was ahead 1-0 in the fourth inning at Wrigley Park, July 30. Right-hander Glen Hobbie walked from the mound to the Cub dugout while his team was at bat and learned his wife had given birth to a son their first child.

The news inspired Hobbie and he bore down the rest of the way and the Cubs ended an eight-game losing streak with a 6-1 count over the league leaders.

Pirate outfielder, Robert Clemente's middle name, according to the official Pirate roster, is Walker.

Lester Biederman, Pittsburgh baseball writer, greeted the Puer-coach Andy Cohen took over temporarily and won the next day. Gene Mauch was named manager but Cohen returned to coaching status with the satisfaction of being the only undefeated manager in the majors.

Pirate righthander Bob Friend was standing in front of a cage at a St. Louis zoo when a tiger thrust his paws through the bars and ripped the pitcher's coat. Friend pulled away his pitching arm in time.

"You're making a joke of this game at Candlestick Park because of an argument over a called strike.

"Look at that scoreboard and see who's making a joke of the game." Dascoli countered to Bob Skinner.

At that moment the Giants were ahead 12-0 and the Pirates had three hits and had been charged with seven errors.

to Rican by his full name early this spring.

"My middle name no Walker," Clemente protested. "It Estretta."

"What does that mean," Biederman asked.

Managerial changes provided oddities. Lou Boudreau, broadcaster of Chicago Cub games, swapped jobs with Cub manager Charlie Grimm.

Managers Trade Men.

Cleveland manager Joe Gordon and Detroit pilot Jimmie Dykes traded portfolios. The teams also traded coaches. Luke Appling joined Dykes in Cleveland and Jo Jo White followed Gordon to Detroit.

Eddie Sawyer quit as Phils manager after the opening game and